Nature of Wash Sc

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POLITICAL ECONOMY.

The second fort is of those which human industry can multiply in proportion to the demand. Where the commodity, a room, is flash as cannot be produced but by human industry, the price is more under than in almost any other cafe. The increasing fearty and confrequency value of land, trends indeed to make it; but this is countertled by its invention of machinery, and improved methods of labour. The opposite agency of these two causes for a soullant tendency to produce uniformity of the value of grain, though we cannot, with Smith, condlier this uniformity as likely to be fo complete, as to consider the price of grain a fure standard for the price of diver.

There are other commodities, however, which nature products in abundance, or which, where land is plant-ful, can be multiplied with little or no cultivation. Of thefe the principal is butche meet. Lands can be co-vered with cattle or they by the labour of the lands and sometimes without any labor at all. Hence, in trade times, butche meet is always cheaper than one. Imimproved periods the reverse is thatcafe. For a long time the price continues confiantly to rife, as we have been it do throughout Great Britain, the autumn area being alone and make concerted into arabile. At left, however, it becomes fo high as to make it an object for the farmer to think cattle, and to cultivate greater for the purpose of feeding them. After this era, the price is likely to experience a certain diminution, from the imported modes of feeding and rearing, which in confidence of the new situation, as likely to be dif-covered and adopted.

There are certain animals, as boys, poultry, Sec, which are fed on more offs, and in a trade state, therefore, are fill cheaper than butcher meet. In an improved that they are doctors: for hery here not as yet at least in his country, become an object of separate cultivation.?

The third fort conflicts of thode, in the multiplication of which the power of man is either limited or uncertain. In their the rule is various. Some commodities are not cultivated on their own account, but are appear dages to others; as wool and hides to the carre of the ox or fleece. Both their commodities are much more portable, and more easily preserved, than the field in the animals from which they are taken; the market for them is thus much more creative, and the demands more equal at all lines. Hence, in such periods, when the flesh of animals, from its abundance, is of finally vache, their appendages equal to force if it in prices. At Baena Ayrter Consequently, and importance in Spain, an oe is killed for the fake of the hide and tallow. In an improved fate of society, on the contrary, the land and forces become considerably inferior to value to the carerule.

7/9 is in article, the topply of which is conferably limited, as man his no power of production in respect to it, though, by the exertion of indultry, he can col- led a greater quantity. Shoals of fish are generally co-pions, but uncertain.

Metal and minerals are articles, the supply of which is not perfectly limited, was extremely uncertain. The different of new mines, or the continuance of fertility in the old, are equally beyond the reach of calculation.

Chup. II.

CHAP.II. _Of the Source of Wealth._

ALL wealth arises from three fourores; it is either produced by the fenomenous beauty of nature, or it is the fruit of human industry, or it is generated by the judicious employment of a quantity of wealth previously accumulated. To the three heads then of _land, lao- border_, and copied, all national wealth may be covered.

Smith has tested of the revenue derived from thefe these figures as forming the constituent parts of the price of commodities; and with regard to labour in particular, repeated conflicts as the way factor of weakly. According to the view, however, given above a Book i the price of all commodities depend entirely on the pro-ch. v.vi.vic. persons between the domestic and the supply. Laonos, therefore, (and the famone may be fast of land and opi- tal), is only a means of furnishing or increasing a supply of their articles for which there already walks abroad, and the units it be beneficial to dooring, the most severe labours will meet with no remoneration whatever. We fulfill therefore proceed to consider the revenue which arise from the deficient causes, and the circumstances by which it is increased or diminished.

Sect. I. Land.

All land which is not naturally burren, and is cultivated, with any cats, afterd something more than is necefary to pay the expense of labouring it. This fur- plus goes as a rest to the husband, who, or couldartion of or rejecting it without risk or trouble, relinquilies to the former the profits of cultivation.

The proportion of the producers of afield which is to go far away, varies with different circumstances. The chief of thefe is the fertility of the foil, the extent of the mask, which enables the producer to be disputed de to greater advantage, the property or poverty of the country, which caules a greater or his demand for that produce, the average-field and activity of the farnes, which will enable them to turn the fertility of the ground to better account. It is almost one-click to delivery, were less for the vague language often made use of upon this subject, that the rate at which farms let, mutl, likeed other commodities, depred altogether upon the demand and the topply if it must is to be made by farming, many will bid for farms, and the rent will be ruled by their competition, and now *early. The idea that all the hundreds of an extensive country may combine to raise their rents, is altogether chimerical. Even could it take place, it could be accomplished only by a certain number of trees allowing their funds to to waste, which, diminishing the topply, would doubtfe ratio the rent of the cultivated lands. But we need not first that any landlad should leave his lands in this condition, from a culpable feheme of ag-gremdizing the refill of his body at his own expense, as well as that of the public.

Land which produces food for men will at all three afford to the landlad, in proportion to its fertility, and the other circumstances mentioned above. Men multiply in proportion to the means of fullerenes they have even a constant tendency to multiply beyond those means; hence there is always a full demand for this species

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Nature of Wealth, &c.

The ſecond ſort is of thoſe which human induſtry can multiply in proportion to the demand. Where the commodity, as corn, is ſuch as cannot be produced but by human induſtry, the price is more uniform than in almoſt any other caſe. The increaſing ſcarcity and conſequently value of land, tends indeed to raiſe it; but this is counteracted by the invention of machinery, and improved methods of labour. The oppoſite agency of theſe two cauſes has a conſtant tendency to preſerve uniformity in the value of grain; though we cannot, with Smith, conſider this uniformity as likely to be ſo complete, as to render the price of grain a ſure ſtandard for the value of ſilver.

There are other commodities, however, which nature produces in abundance, or which, where land is plentiful, can be multiplied with little or no cultivation. Of theſe the principal is butcher meat. Lands can be covered with cattle or ſheep by the labour of few hands, and ſometimes without any labour at all. Hence, in rude times, butcher meat is always cheaper than corn; in improved periods, the reverſe is the caſe. For a long time the price continues conſtantly to riſe, as we have ſeen it do throughout Great Britain, the paſture lands being more and more converted into arable. At laſt, however, it becomes ſo high as to make it an object for the farmer to ſtall his cattle, and to cultivate ground for the purpoſe of feeding them. After this era, the price is likely to experience a certain diminution, from the improved modes of feeding and rearing, which, in conſequence of this new attention, are likely to be diſcovered and adopted.

There are certain animals, as hogs, poultry, &c. which are fed on mere offals, and in a rude ſtate, therefore, are ſtill cheaper than butcher meat. In an improved ſtate they are dearer; for they have not as yet, at leaſt in this country, become an object of ſeparate cultivation.

The third ſort conſiſts of thoſe, in the multiplication of which the power of man is either limited or uncertain. In theſe the rule is various. Some commodities are not cultivated on their own account, but are appendages to others; as wool and hides to the carcaſe of the ox or ſheep. Both theſe commodities are much more portable, and more eaſily preſerved, than the fleſh of the animals from which they are taken; the market for them is thus much more extenſive, and the demand more equal at all times. Hence, in rude periods, when the fleſh of animals, from its abundance, is of ſmall value, theſe appendages equal or ſurpaſs it in price. At Buenos Ayres frequently, and ſometimes even in Spain, an ox is killed for the ſake of the hide and tallow. In an improved ſtate of ſociety, on the contrary, the hide and fleece become conſiderably inferior in value to the carcaſe.

Fiſh is an article, the ſupply of which is conſiderably limited, as man has no power of production in reſpect to it, though, by the exertion of induſtry, he can collect a greater quantity. Shoals of fiſh are generally copious, but uncertain.

Metals and minerals are articles, the ſupply of which is not preciſely limited, but extremely uncertain. The diſcovery of new mines, or the continuance of fertility in the old, are equally beyond the reach of calculation.

Chap. II. *Of the Sources of Wealth.*

Source of Wealth.

All wealth ariſes from three ſources; it is either produced by the ſpontaneous bounty of nature, or it is the fruit of human induſtry, or it is generated by the judicious employment of a quantity of wealth previouſly accumulated. To theſe three heads then of *land*, *labour*, and *capital*, all national wealth may be referred.

Smith has treated of the revenue derived from theſe three ſources as forming the conſtituent parts of the price of commodities; and with regard to labour in particular, repeatedly conſiders it as the only ſource of wealth*. According to the view, however, given above, the price of all commodities depends entirely on the proportion between the demand and the ſupply. Labour, therefore, (and the ſame may be ſaid of land and capital), is only a means of furniſhing or increaſing a ſupply of thoſe articles for which there already exiſts a demand, and unleſs it be ſucceſsful in ſo doing, the moſt ſevere labours will meet with no remuneration whatever. We ſhall therefore proceed to conſider the revenue which ariſes from theſe different ſources, and the circumſtances by which it is increaſed or diminiſhed.

* Book i. ch. v. vi. vii.

Sect. I. *Land.*

All land which is not naturally barren, and is cultivated with any eaſe, affords ſomething more than is neceſſary to pay the expence of labouring it. This ſurplus goes as a rent to the landlord, who, in conſideration of receiving it without riſk or trouble, relinquiſhes to the farmer the profits of cultivation.

The proportion of the produce of a field which is to go for rent, varies with different circumſtances. The chief of theſe is the fertility of the ſoil, the extent of the market, which enables the produce to be diſpoſed of to greater advantage, the proſperity or poverty of the country, which cauſes a greater or leſs demand for that produce, and the average ſkill and activity of the farmers, which will enable them to turn the fertility of the ground to better account. It is almoſt needleſs to obſerve, were it not for the vague language often made uſe of upon this ſubject, that the rate at which farms let, muſt, like all other commodities, depend altogether upon the demand and the ſupply. If much is to be made by farming, many will bid for farms, and the rent will be raiſed by their competition, and *vice verſa*. The idea that all the landlords of an extenſive country may combine to raiſe their rents, is altogether chimerical. Even could it take place, it could be accompliſhed only by a certain number of them allowing their lands to lie waſte, which, diminiſhing the ſupply, would doubtleſs raiſe the rent of the cultivated lands. But we need not fear that any landlord ſhould leave his lands in this condition, from a culpable ſcheme of aggrandizing the reſt of his body at his own expence, as well as that of the public.

Land which produces food for man will at all times afford rent to the landlord, in proportion to its fertility, and the other circumſtances mentioned above. Men multiply in proportion to the means of ſubſiſtence; they have even a conſtant tendency to multiply beyond theſe means; hence there is always a full demand for this ſpecies

Figure 1: *
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